

SBI Clerk 2026 — Exam Pattern, Syllabus & Preparation Guide

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Phase I — Preliminary examination (100 marks, 1 hour)

Section	Questions	Marks	Duration
English Language	30	30	20 minutes
Numerical Ability	35	35	20 minutes
Reasoning Ability	35	35	20 minutes
Total	100	100	60 minutes

Negative marking of 1/4th mark applies for every wrong answer. Prelims marks are only for shortlisting — about 10 times the vacancies per category are called for the Main exam.

Phase II — Main examination (200 marks, 2 hours 40 minutes)

Section	Questions	Marks	Duration
General / Financial Awareness	50	50	35 minutes
General English	40	40	35 minutes
Quantitative Aptitude	50	50	45 minutes
Reasoning Ability & Computer Aptitude	50	60	45 minutes
Total	190	200	160 minutes

Only Main examination marks decide the final merit. SBI apprentices who completed one year of branch experience get bonus marks of 5 out of 200.

Phase III — Local language proficiency test

Part	Pattern	Passages	Questions	Marks
Non-verbal comprehension	Objective	3	15	15
Writing / translation	Descriptive	-	As specified	As specified

Candidates who produce a Class 10 or Class 12 mark sheet showing study of the opted local language are exempt from this test.

Topic checklist

Quantitative Aptitude — Simplification and approximation, number series, quadratic equations, data interpretation, percentage, ratio, average, profit and loss, time-speed-distance, time and work, simple and compound interest, mensuration, permutation and probability.

Reasoning & Computer Aptitude — Puzzles and seating arrangement, syllogism, inequality, blood relations, direction sense, coding-decoding, order and ranking, input-output, computer fundamentals, MS Office, internet and networking, shortcut keys, computer abbreviations.

English Language — Reading comprehension, cloze test, para jumbles, sentence improvement, error spotting, fill in the blanks, word usage, vocabulary and idioms.

General / Financial Awareness — Banking awareness, RBI functions and policy rates, financial and budget terms, current affairs of the last six months, government schemes, static GK, capital-currency and appointments.

Preparation plan

- Weeks 1-3: build speed in the three Prelims sections with 20-minute sectional timers, since each section is separately timed.
- Weeks 4-6: attempt two full-length mock tests every week and maintain an error log for wrong answers.
- Weeks 7-8: shift focus to General / Financial Awareness and Computer Aptitude, which decide the Main exam merit.
- Continuous: revise the last six months of banking current affairs weekly and practise the opted local language if you have no Class 10 or 12 proof.